

POLICY: REFUND & COMPENSATION

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Department	Finance & Customer Operations

1. Scope

Governs all refunds, bill credits, and goodwill compensation. Agent authority is capped per tier. Exceeding authority without escalation is a violation.

2. Rules

2.1 Eligibility

FIN-RULE-001	A refund or credit may only be issued if the claim maps to one of five categories: (1) Service Outage > 24 hours verified, (2) Billing Error, (3) Speed < 50% of advertised plan (hardwired test), (4) Cooling-Off Period within 14 days of contract start, (5) Unauthorized/Fraudulent Charge.	MAJOR
FIN-RULE-002	Subjective performance complaints without supporting system data (e.g. 'internet feels slow') are not grounds for a credit.	MAJOR
FIN-RULE-003	Speed test evidence for refund eligibility must be from a hardwired (ethernet) test. WiFi-based tests are not accepted.	MAJOR

2.2 Compensation Matrix

Scenario	Compensation
Service outage < 24 hours	Apology only — no financial credit
Service outage 24–72 hours	Pro-rated: (days ÷ 30) × monthly charge
Service outage > 72 hours	Full month credit + \$10 goodwill credit
Billing error (any amount)	100% reversal of erroneous amount
Missed tech appointment — 1st occurrence	\$25 account credit
Missed tech appointment — repeat occurrence	\$50 account credit + priority reschedule
Speed/signal < 50% of plan (verified)	Plan downgrade retroactive to report date OR contract exit without ETF
Hardware dead on arrival	Free expedited replacement + shipping refund

2.3 Authorization Limits

FIN-RULE-004	No agent may apply a credit exceeding their tier authority. Credits above the agent's limit require a Credit Approval Request to the next tier before any amount is communicated to the customer.	CRITICAL
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Role	Max Credit Per Transaction	Billing Codes
Tier 1 Agent	\$25.00	ADJ-COURTESY or ADJ-OUTAGE
Tier 2 Senior Agent	\$75.00	—
Tier 3 Team Lead	\$200.00	—
Tier 4 Operations Manager	Unlimited	—

FIN-RULE-005	Agent must never promise a refund amount to the customer before authorization is confirmed.	CRITICAL
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2.4 Anti-Fraud Controls

FIN-RULE-006	Courtesy credits are limited to one per account per 180-day period. The billing system will block a second application. Manager override (Tier 3+) required if blocked.	MAJOR
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FIN-RULE-007	Accounts with more than 3 refund requests in 90 days are automatically flagged. Agent must transfer to Tier 2 for a revenue assurance review.	MAJOR
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FIN-RULE-008	Fraud and unauthorized charge cases must never be resolved at Tier 1. Immediate Tier 2 transfer is required.	CRITICAL
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FIN-RULE-009	Cooling-off period refunds (within 14 days of contract start) are no-questions-asked full refunds, provided equipment is returned in good condition.	MAJOR
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2.5 Refund Timelines

Refund Type	Processing Time	Agent Script
Bill credit (active account)	5–10 business days online; next PDF bill cycle	The balance on your online account will update within 5 days but will officially appear on your next PDF bill.
Card/bank reversal	15–30 days	We have processed the refund today, but depending on your bank it may take 1–2 billing cycles to appear.
Mailed check	4–6 weeks	A check has been issued and will arrive via standard mail within 30 business days.

FIN-RULE-010	Agent must communicate the correct refund timeline using the approved script above. Quoting timelines from memory is prohibited.	MAJOR
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